

PROSCIUTTO AND GOAT CHEESE-FILLED CAPPELLETTI WITH PISTACHIOS

SERVES
4-6

TOTAL TIME
2 h plus the dough rest

INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Egg dough
128 g	Prosciutto, in a single piece
116 g	Ricotta
114 g	Spinach leaves, lightly packed
168 g	Fresh goat cheese
22 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated, for the filling
18 g	Egg yolk
45 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
31 g	Raw Sicilian pistachios, very finely chopped
22 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated, to finish
quantity not given	Salt

METHOD

1. Chill the meat grinder and all its dies for at least an hour before you grind anything.
2. Cut the prosciutto into cubes of ½ to 1 inch and give them about 15 minutes in the freezer. They want to be colder than a refrigerator gets them, without freezing.
3. Fit the grinder with the larger of two dies, or the middle one of three, and run the prosciutto through twice. Set it aside.
4. Pulse the ricotta in a food processor just to a glossy, frosting-smooth state and no further. Over-processing breaks it. Scrape it into a bowl.
5. Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to the boil over high heat. Set up a salted ice bath with a colander standing in it.
6. Boil the spinach about a minute, until tender but still bright green, then move it into the ice bath to stop it cooking. Drain it, turn it out onto a kitchen towel and squeeze the water out.
7. Chop the dry spinach finely.
8. Combine the whipped ricotta, goat cheese, ground prosciutto, spinach and parmigiano in a bowl and mix until everything is evenly integrated. Taste and adjust with salt. It wants to taste properly seasoned. Stir the egg yolk through and refrigerate until you are ready to pipe.
9. Make 70 to 80 cappelletti with the egg dough and the filling.
10. Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to the boil over high heat.
11. Set a large saute pan over low heat, drop the butter in and pour in 115 to 170 g of pasta water, 2 to 3 ladles. Swirl to emulsify.
12. Slide the cappelletti into the pot and pull the heat back to a gentle simmer. A rolling boil breaks this filling. Cook 2 to 4 minutes. The thickest closure should give tenderly.
13. Lift them across with a spider, raise the heat to medium and swirl 30 seconds to a minute, turning them with a spoon so every side is coated. A splash more pasta water loosens the sauce if it tightens. It is ready when it clings with a gloss.
14. Divide onto plates, drizzle the sauce left in the pan over the top and finish with the pistachios and parmigiano.

NOTES

Grind the prosciutto cold. Chilled grinder, chilled dies, 15 minutes in the freezer for the cubes, or the fat smears instead of cutting cleanly.

Ricotta is doing structural work here. It covers for the chalkiness of goat cheese and tempers its tang.

Whip the ricotta only to a frosting-like sheen. Past that point it breaks.

Squeeze the blanched spinach properly dry before chopping it, otherwise it loosens the filling.

Nuts and bread crumbs over pasta are a southern Italian habit more than a northern one. The pistachios give texture and a faint sweetness.

FILLING

Prosciutto, Goat Cheese and Spinach Filling

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114 g	Spinach leaves, lightly packed
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7. Drain the spinach, turn it out onto a kitchen towel and squeeze the water out, then chop it finely.
8. Combine the whipped ricotta, goat cheese, ground prosciutto, spinach and parmigiano in a bowl and mix until everything is evenly integrated. Taste and adjust with salt. It wants to taste properly seasoned.
9. Stir the egg yolk through and refrigerate until you are ready to pipe.

NOTES

Everything that touches the prosciutto stays cold. Chilled grinder, chilled dies, 15 minutes in the freezer for the cubes, or the fat smears instead of cutting.

Grind the prosciutto twice. One pass leaves it too coarse to pipe.

Ricotta is doing structural work, not just bulking the mix. It covers for the chalkiness of goat cheese and tempers the tang.

Whip the ricotta only to a frosting-like sheen. Past that it breaks.

Squeeze the blanched spinach properly dry before chopping it, otherwise the water loosens the filling.

SHAPE

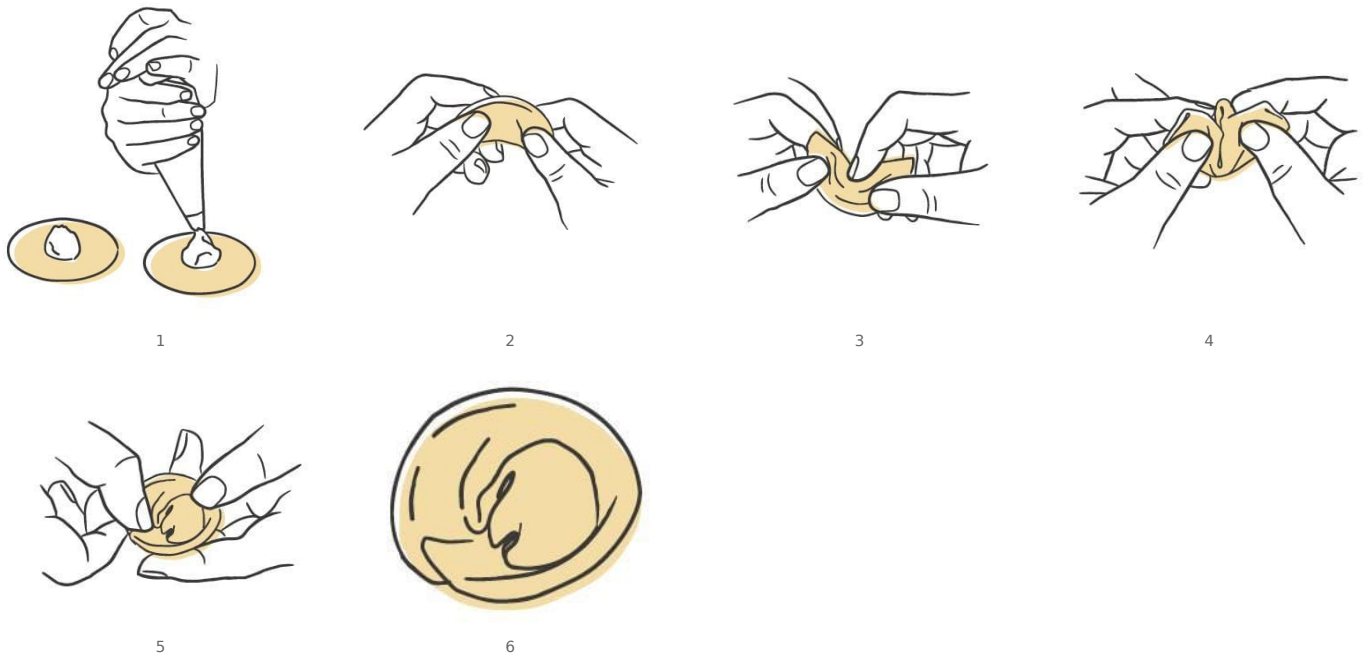
Cappelletti

Region: Emilia-Romagna, particularly Reggio Emilia / Rest: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator

METHOD

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Lay one sheet on the board. Cut rounds with a #70 (2 3/4-inch) round cutter, plain or fluted, spacing them about 1/8 inch apart.
4. Load the filling into a pastry bag cut to a 1/2-inch opening. Pipe a quarter-sized dab of filling into the middle of each round.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist the rounds with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Hold a round in your palm and fold the top half over the bottom half, lining up the edges, to make a half-moon.
7. Pinch the edge shut around the filling with thumb and index finger. Work back and forth a few times and push all the air out.
8. Press a dimple into the center of the filled side with your index finger.
9. With the dimple facing you, take hold of the two ends of the half-moon and draw them toward each other on a slight downward angle. Overlap the two ends and pinch them shut.
10. Set the piece on the prepared pan. Fill and fold the rest of the rounds, keeping them in a single layer, and dust the pan again with semolina.
11. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
12. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

SHAPING



NOTES

Cut from 2 3/4-inch rounds (#70 cutter), plain or fluted, spaced 1/8 inch apart on the sheet.

Filling per piece: a quarter-sized circle piped through a 1/2-inch opening.

The shape is defined by being cut from circles rather than squares and by being fastened tightly against the filling.

Seal geometry: fold to a half-moon, pinch the edge closed, dimple the filled side, then bring the two ends together on a slight downward angle, cross them, and pinch. Tortellini instead wrap the tips into a ring underneath and flatten the joint.

Air must be forced out of the edge before the ends are joined.

A common variation flips the brim up into a collar that hugs the filling.

Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.

Served with a bold filling against a restrained sauce so the shape carries the plate. Butter with pepper works, as does butter loosened with pasta water and finished with fennel pollen.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.

Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.

Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.

Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.